

OE3C Planning Meeting 9

Date: 19 Feb 2026

Location: Online

Time: 11:01 AM – 12:13 PM

Attendees: Lyllian Corbin, Alex Wilder, Kiyoko Gotanda, Reem Mahamoud, Rasa Khosrowshahli, Sarah Hein, Nicholas Benton, Matthew Summerville, Madelaine Legault, Cassia Hamilton, Wylan Clitheroe, Katherine Yagi

Chair: Alex Wilder

Minutes by: Lyllian Corbin

[Recap: OE3C Standing Meeting time Thursday, February 19 | Meeting | Microsoft Teams](#)

Alex began the meeting at 11:01 AM.

Call of Order and Approval of Meeting Minutes

- Meeting minutes were approved

Keynote Update

- Quick update from Alex (on Kiyoko's behalf)
 - o Kiyoko confirmed that flights and hotels are good for Nancy Chen (Evolution keynote)
 - She'll take care of insurance, etc., after returning from the field
- Update from Harry
 - o Confirmed that Jesse Popp from Guelph will be the Ecology keynote speaker
 - o Discussion on Ethology keynote
 - Sarah Benson from UBC can't make it but is willing to do an online seminar (was going to be the ethology keynote)
 - We prefer all of the keynotes to be in-person
 - Alternative: Sarah could do a webinar leading up to the conference

- Quinn Webber from Guelph was going to be invited, but Kiyoko suggested inviting someone from a different institution because we already have someone from Guelph
- Melanie from McGill will be invited to be the Ethology keynote
- Pictures for Jess and Nancy are available on Teams for social media posts and for the OE3C website

Registration Update

- Reem was talking with Lucas about the website
 - Everything should be good to go
 - Link for review: <https://brocku.universitytickets.com/w/event.aspx?id=2736>
- Lauren will send the link to other universities if the link is good
- Reem asked if Brock's Conference Services also takes care of name badges
 - Alex and Reem are unsure
 - Kiyoko might have confirmation of the agreement with CS in the OE3C Gmail
 - We want to include the logo on the name tags
 - We might place our own printing order through Brock's Printing Services
 - Or we could buy template tags and print them ourselves

Social Media and Website Update

- Social media update with Matt
 - Matt was working on a social media post for Jesse Popp
 - Included colours from the medicine wheel as a background but wanted feedback on the idea
 - Alex suggested that Matt confirm if Jesse's tribe uses the medicine wheel, or avoid using the colours if unsure
 - Matt will reach out to Jesse with questions to confirm her tribe and any symbols they use
- Website update with Rasa
 - Rasa added new version of conference schedule with Sarah's help
 - Added registration link and Cassia's parking map
 - Needs to add specific information such as location of the prayer room
 - Sarah mentioned that the schedule formatting might have been changed once the image uploaded
 - Rasa will try reupload the image
 - Questions from Madelaine (*appended from the meeting chat*):

- The word "colloquium" is spelled incorrectly on the schedule page of the website.
- Didn't Kiyoko ask that the photography workshop not start at 9, as she wanted a later time? It is showing as 9-11
- Can we include the mindfulness hike in the schedule for the last day?
- If we are doing the scavenger hunt, art gallery and photography competition display throughout the conference, can we include a section that indicates this, perhaps at the bottom of the schedule? (e.g., "Running throughout the Colloquium" section)?
- The activity information section on the website still has that photo of the vineyard lunch that may be a misleading photo for potential attendees (can we get a photo of wine bottles or the wine library?)
- Can we remove the heading that says "planning excursions"? We have one excursion. I think "Activity Information" is sufficient.
- Once we have a time for the CCOVI tour(s) and a name for the Indigenous ecology workshop, can we update the schedule accordingly? I will send the info as soon as it is confirmed.

Catering Update with Alex

- We cannot have lunches or breakfast in DeCew Hall (the hall will not be available during the conference dates)
 - If we do request the hall be available, we will be charged for excess food and staff if people don't go to lunch
- Breakfast will not be included
 - We will have coffee and refreshments
- Nichole from Brock Dining suggested a lunch box buffet
 - To go box with buffet of lunch options
 - Staff will be present to help and make sure people take appropriate portions
 - Buffet can be set up in Pond
 - Lillian agreed with this option – no one objected

Banquet Update with Cassia

- We received approval to host the banquet in Market Hall
- Nichole gave a quote for catering
 - Went with the maximum costs for 100 people
 - Refreshments
 - Regular and decaf coffee, tea, and water
 - Mocktails

- Alcoholic drinks
 - Corkage fee (\$10)
 - Food
 - Vegetarian and non-vegetarian menu
 - Bar and bartender
 - Linens and China
- Total quote = \$8209.22
 - Alex confirmed that if all 100 people attended and paid their \$90 ticket, we would still make ~\$100 profit after these costs
 - Alex uploaded the catering quote on Teams
- Reviewing the Celebration Menu options to select the menu we want to have for the banquet...
 - We agreed to having a Soup + Salad to start
 - Spring themed salad (some options listed below were pointed out by the committee)
 - Strawberry salad
 - Kale and roasted root veggie
 - *Sarah made a note that vegetarians cannot have Caesar dressing*
 - Three-sister soup
 - Pasta
 - Will likely be a simple dish with pasta and marinara sauce
 - Protein
 - Asiago chicken (we agreed)
 - Poached Niagara Trout (we agreed)
 - Dessert
 - Assorted Mini Squares
 - Sangria (Red)

Workshops and Outings Update

- Alex confirmed that Kiyoko likes the idea of hosting the scavenger hunt throughout the conference
- Workshops update with Nick
 - Still figuring out the computer science workshop
 - Sowmya gave some practice examples, but they were 6 hrs long
 - Nick is working on shortening the coding exercises
 - Art gallery
 - Kiyoko mentioned getting contacts of artists
 - Nick will chat more with Kiyoko on this when she returns
 - Need tables to display the art

- Kiyoko confirmed that we will submit requests for tables when we submit the room configuration plan for Pond Inlet
- **Alex noted that anything we need booked for rooms should be discussed with Kiyoko**
- Outings update with Madelaine
 - Connected with Taylor from CCOVI
 - Tastings are allocated to specific times (on conference schedule)
 - \$20 per bottle for the tastings
 - Alex suggested to ask CCOVI if they are willing to donate bottles
 - Madelaine will have a planning meeting with Taylor
 - Indigenous ecology workshop – will be working with Alex on coordinating that
 - PollUnit – will begin working on the platform to host the photo competition

Schedule

- We did not have any major updates, changes, or discussion for this section

Merch Update

- T-shirt order update with Lauren
 - The sportswear store can't do stickers but we could try making the stickers through MakerSpace
 - Conference T-shirts discussion
 - Results from Sarah's poll: 62% of committee liked crewneck option, 48% of committee liked V-neck option
 - Sarah suggested ordering 50/50 of each option
 - We agreed to having light grey shirts with "Committee" written on them
 - Lauren will send out a form to confirm sizes and shirt style
 - Wanted to confirm if she should do multiple orders (e.g., in case we need to order more for volunteers and conference attendees later)?
 - Alex asked how long the sportswear store needs to process orders
 - Lauren confirmed they should be able to complete the order in a couple weeks
 - Alex advised coming back to this discussion in the next meeting
 - Shirts will be put up for sale on the registration page for \$20

- Katherine confirmed that having the option up early will be good so we know the shirt sizes in advance
- Discussing notebook options from VistaPrint with Katherine
 - We want a notebook that comes with a pen
 - Some notebooks are printed with colour, some are printed in black & white only
 - Notebooks that come with a pen and are printed in colour (to include the OE3C logo) will be more expensive
 - Alex confirmed that Paige will be reigned into to this discussion to help with selecting the notebooks
 - We also viewed an example swag bag to hand out instead of tote bags (bag is all white with black drawstring handles)
 - We agreed to having swag bags with a large OE3C logo printed on the bag

Meeting was adjourned at 12:13 PM.

Appended Notes

06 Mar 2026: *The following points were appended from Madelaine's notes:*

CCOVI Tour/Tastings

- Connected with Taylor, indicated interest in participating for tour(s) and tasting(s)
 - Do we see an advantage in multiple tours across a couple days?
 - All on one day, staggered starts between 11-2 on 30th
 - Or, on days 2 and 3 running concurrently with talks
 - Tastings would be good around social hours in evenings (30th?)
 - Tastings would have cost for wine at around \$20 per bottle
 - Planning meeting Mon 23rd at 11 on teams, will share meeting link
- Indigenous workshop planning TBD, still waiting to connect with Cindy
- Photography competition
 - Poll Unit seems to still be the preferred choice, but please lmk by end of month if otherwise (if no comments by Mar 1, request for funds will be submitted and PollUnit account will be created)
 - Will connect with Matt for social media promotion before end of Feb, hoping to start advertising by end of Mar for early April submission opening